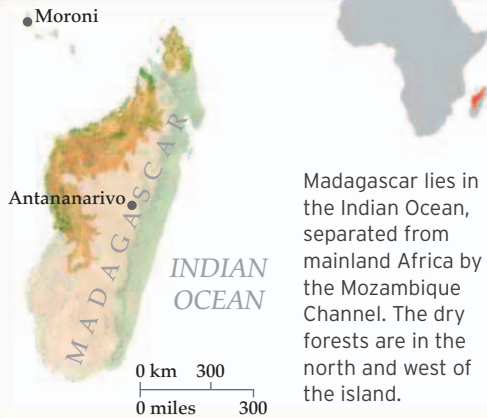
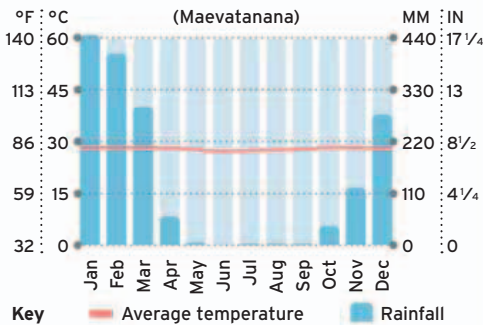


LOCATION



CLIMATE

Prevailing southeasterly winds drop most of their moisture on the central highlands before reaching the island's western areas.



Fosa

Cryptoprocta ferox

Although they look like cats, fosas belong to a group of mammals thought to have evolved from a prehistoric mongooselike ancestor. Madagascar's largest predator, the fosa is active both day and night, and is able to hunt small mammals, birds, and reptiles in trees as well as on the ground. Because they occasionally take domestic poultry, fosas are targeted by local farmers as a pest.



semiretractable claws provide good grip in trees

- 28–32 in (71–81 cm)
- 12–19 lb (5.5–8.5 kg)
- Vulnerable
- Lemurs, tenrecs, birds



UNIQUE FEATURES
The fosa's catlike head ends in a doglike snout, and when walking slowly, it keeps its heels on the ground like a bear—or a human.

Berthe's mouse lemur

Microcebus berthae

The smallest living primate, this solitary nocturnal mammal spends its life in trees, searching for food around 33 ft (10 m) off the ground. Berthe's mouse lemurs enter a state of torpor during the day, lowering their metabolism and temperature to conserve energy.

TINY PRIMATE
Berthe's mouse lemurs use all four limbs to run quickly along branches, leaping to flee from predators such as owls or fosas.

- 4 in (10 cm)
- 1 oz (28 g)
- Endangered
- Fruit, gum, honeydew



reptile species are endemic

BURROWING RAT
The Malagasy giant jumping rat occupies a similar burrowing niche to rabbits, which are absent from Madagascar. This endemic rodent's feeding and burrowing behaviors are important in seed dispersal and soil aeration.

GIANT JUMPING RAT

